

Participant Consent Form

GUEP/NICR Approval Number [Insert]

Participant number: P1

Research Project Title: Sequential Transfer Learning for Medicinal Plant Identification: Endangered Species Protection and Sustainable Harvesting

	Please initial box
I confirm that I have read and understood the Participant Information Sheet dated November 2025 explaining the above research project and I have had the opportunity to ask questions about the project. I understand that this study is evaluating how clearly a machine learning system presents its plant identification predictions and confidence scores. And I am not being tested on my knowledge of plants or technical ability.	
I understand that my participation is voluntary and that I am free to withdraw at any time during the study and withdraw my data within [provide timeframe] without giving a reason, and without any penalty. I understand that beyond [provide timeframe, when data analysis has started/results are published] it may not be possible to remove my data from the study.	
I understand that my responses will be kept anonymous [if true] and I give permission for members of the research team to have access to my anonymised responses [if true].	
I understand that taking part means attending a single 20–30 minute session, where I will view example outputs from the plant identification model and complete several short tasks on interface clarity. I will also answer a brief questionnaire at the end. No prior technical knowledge or plant expertise is required.	
I understand that my data will be collected anonymously using a participant code (not my name), and only this code will be used on all responses. The data will be securely stored, accessible only to the researcher and supervisor, and will be handled in line with UK GDPR.	
I understand that my anonymous responses will help improve how the model presents information and may be included in the researcher’s dissertation. Only aggregated, non-identifiable data will be reported, and I will not be personally identified in any results or publications.	
I understand that the study presents very low risk, involves no sensitive topics, and that I may take a break or withdraw from participation at any time if I wish.	
Participant Details: Age Group: (tick one): ☐ 18–25 years old ☐ 26–35 years old ☐ 36–45 years old ☐ 46+ years old Have you studied biology before? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Prefer not to say	
I agree to take part in this study	

Name of Participant

Signature:

Date: [Click here to enter a date](#)

Name of Researcher

Signature: **M.Hareeshwar**

Date: Hareeshwar Muthukumaran